

ONT pitch deck

I pulled two live checks before writing, because both benches flagged the tape as unresolved and it is the primary input. Results are folded into the deck below.

- **IBKR live rail: attempted, permission not granted in this non-interactive session.** So no tick. The connector needs authorization before any order can be worked.
- **Tape reconciled anyway** via a secondary source, and the primary 8-K text was re-fetched from the company IR venue (SEC.gov 403s direct, as both benches reported).

PITCH — ONT — VERDICT

PROPOSED — PENDING ADJUDICATION — no position, no order; do not buy at \$15.33; arm a band at \$14.45 that only becomes live after the Q3 print clears two named gates.

What we believe

Onterris (formerly Montrose Environmental Group; NYSE: ONT) cut its 2026 forecast on August 5th and the stock fell about 17.5% that day. It is now roughly 51% below its 52-week high of \$31.21.

We believe the market priced the *revenue* cut and largely ignored what the company said the revenue cut was **made of**. From the company's own release:

Driver of the revenue cut	Amount	What it is
Pass-through revenue	-\$35M to -\$55M	Costs billed straight through to customers at near-zero margin
Emergency response revenue	-\$35M to -\$45M	Cleanup work after environmental accidents — a lottery, not a demand curve
"Other" revenue	-\$15M to -\$25M	Unlabeled

Source: [Onterris Q2 2026 results release](#) (mirrors 8-K exhibit, accession [0001193125-26-335022](#)).

Two things follow, and they are the thesis:

1. The profit cut is small and the revenue cut is mostly not about profit. Revenue guidance went from \$840–900M to \$740–790M — a \$105M cut at the midpoint, –12.1%. Profit guidance (adjusted EBITDA) went from \$125–130M to \$117–120M — a \$9M cut, –7.1%. That means only about 8.6 cents of profit was lost per dollar of revenue lost. That is the arithmetic signature of removing revenue that was never earning much. About \$85M of the \$105M cut — 81% — sits in the two buckets the company *named*, and one of those buckets (pass-through) carries almost no profit at all.

2. The emergency-response decline is a base effect, and the company said so. The release states the quarter had “historically low environmental emergency response and related recovery service

revenues,” against “an abnormally high prior-year quarter driven by a single environmental event.” That is one big accident in mid-2025 not repeating in mid-2026. It is weather and industrial-accident frequency, not customers leaving.

The operating evidence supports this. In Q2, the Consulting & Treatment segment lost 27% of its revenue (\$171.7M → \$125.6M) and its **profit margin went up**, 21.9% → 22.2%. Company-wide margin also rose, 16.9% → 17.1%. A business genuinely losing demand does not expand margin while shrinking that fast; a business shedding pass-through revenue does exactly that.

Meanwhile the market marked the equity down 17.5% on a 7.1% profit cut. At a constant multiple, a \$9M profit cut is worth about \$1.88 per share, roughly 10%. The extra ~7 points is the market re-rating the multiple and pricing a governance discount. That gap is what we would be buying — *if* the price ever gets to our band, and if the fourth-quarter question below gets answered.

But we are not proposing to buy. The verdict is flat, for the reasons in the next three sections.

What the market believes

- **A roll-up whose model just broke.** The company bought its way to ~\$830M of revenue and is now guiding revenue *down* 7.9% while still acquiring — which means the underlying, non-acquired business is shrinking faster than 7.9%. That reading is fair, and neither of our benches refuted it.
- **Management can’t forecast.** The company **reiterated** full-year guidance on May 6th and cut it \$105M on August 5th — nine weeks later. In between, it spent \$29.987M buying back its own stock at roughly \$18.75 a share, funded by drawing \$67.213M on its credit line, while operating cash flow for the half was **negative \$5.481M**. The stock is now \$15.33. Management bought high with borrowed money, weeks before telling the market the year was worse than it had just confirmed.
- **The board is playing defense.** On the same night as the cut, the board announced a “comprehensive Board-led strategic review” with no deadline, and adopted a shareholder rights plan (a “poison pill”) in response to what it described as undisclosed accumulation of shares and derivatives. A review with no end date plus a takeover defense is a combination the market reads as entrenchment.
- **“Adjusted” profit isn’t real profit.** Roughly \$38M a year of the “adjusted EBITDA” is stock issued to employees, added back. That is about 32% of the \$118.5M guide. Add ~\$25M of capital spending and the cash the business actually generates for owners is far smaller than the headline.
- **The balance sheet has no book value.** Goodwill and intangibles total \$579.4M against total equity of \$430.3M — tangible equity is roughly **negative \$149M**. The market capitalization (\$538M) is now below the carrying value of what the roll-up bought. A write-down is likely.

Why we might have edge

Stated honestly, and ranked by how much we actually trust each one.

1. **We read the bridge; the tape read the headline.** The distinction between “revenue fell” and “near-zero-margin revenue fell” is in the release, in plain English, with dollar amounts. It requires no modeling — only reading past the first paragraph. Sell-side notes on print day led with the revenue miss and the 17.5% drop. This is a *small, real, and short-lived* edge.
2. **The emergency-response line is a lottery draw, and lotteries revert.** If the driver is “no single large environmental event this year,” then the correct forecast for next year is the long-run event frequency, not zero. Both of our benches initially mis-framed this as a demand or a regulatory problem. It is neither.
3. **The third-quarter margin is guided, not guessed.** The company published Q3 guidance of \$190–210M revenue at **17.0–18.0%** margin. At the midpoint that is $\$200\text{M} \times 17.5\% = \text{\$35.0M}$ — versus \$33.7M in Q3 2025 on \$224.9M. Profit up ~4% on revenue down ~11%. If that prints, the mix story is confirmed on the tape rather than argued in a memo. Our red bench asserted “no source” for the second-half profit step while this published guide sat in the document it was quoting.
4. **A possible classification artifact.** ONT carries SIC code 8742 (management consulting), which routes it into consumer-discretionary screens despite being an environmental testing and remediation business. Both benches independently noticed this misrouted eight of our own detectors. If it also misroutes index and quantitative flows, part of the 51% drawdown may be a classification accident rather than a fundamental judgment. **We have not verified this** — it is a hypothesis, not a finding.
5. **The takeover overhang has a hard expiry we can date.** The rights plan is *limited-duration* and expires **August 4, 2027** (confirmed in the release). Our red bench called it entrenchment without disclosing this. A one-year limited-duration pill adopted in response to accumulation is the governance-acceptable form, not the abusive form. It caps the accumulator at 14.9% for twelve months — a real constraint, but a dated one.

Why it might be priced in

This section is longer than the one above, which is itself informative.

- **Our own record on this exact setup is 0 for 7.** We have run the “market overreacted to a headline at a post-print dislocation” template seven times and lost or gone nowhere every time. The lesson we recorded was: *the headline is the news*. This pitch is that template. That prior should carry more weight than any single argument above.
- **The fourth quarter is unearned.** Full-year guidance is \$117–120M. Subtract the first half (approximately \$53M) and the guided third quarter (\$35.0M) and roughly **\$29–32M** must arrive in Q4 — against about \$24M in Q4 2025, on a lower revenue base. That implies roughly 230–320 basis points of year-over-year margin expansion with no named source, worth about **\$5–8M of profit, or \$1.30–\$2.05 per share at 9x**. This is the one objection that survived both benches, and it is real. It is also *smaller* than either bench claimed (see the table below).
- **A second cut is live.** The team that reiterated in May and cut in August is the same team standing behind the Q4 number. Their demonstrated forecast half-life is under one quarter.

- **On cash, not “adjusted profit,” it is not cheap.** Enterprise value is roughly \$874.7M (\$538.4M market cap + ~\$336.3M net debt). Against guided profit of \$118.5M that is 7.4x. But subtract the ~\$38M of stock compensation and ~\$25M of capital spending that the adjusted number adds back, and you are paying about **15.8x** actual owner cash flow for a business with declining revenue. Our red bench’s version of this (17x) used an inflated enterprise value, but the *direction* is correct and blue never rebutted it. This is red’s best surviving point.
- **The cash statement is worse than the profit statement.** First-half operating cash flow was -\$5.481M versus +\$27.398M a year earlier. And that was *helped* by receivables, which were a \$15.0M source of cash this year versus a \$27.4M use last year. Strip that out and underlying cash generation deteriorated by roughly \$59M year over year against a net loss deterioration of only \$10.3M. **Nobody has explained the difference.**
- **Leverage limits the room to be wrong.** Net leverage is 3.20x against a 3.75x covenant — about 0.55 turns of headroom, or roughly a 15% shortfall in covenant profit before a breach. That is not imminent, but it is why any position here must be small.
- **A write-down is probably coming.** Market cap below the carrying value of acquired assets, after a 51% drawdown and a guidance cut, is a textbook trigger. Non-cash, but it will produce a headline and it is an admission the roll-up overpaid.

What could go wrong

(Pre-mortem. Three failure narratives, worst first. The second has no sensor we can build.)

Failure 1 — The mix story is true and the fourth quarter still misses. Everything in “What we believe” can be correct — pass-through is low-margin, emergency response is a base effect, segment margins held — and the year still comes in at \$108–112M instead of \$117–120M, because the Q4 margin step was always aspirational. Management then cuts again in November or guides 2027 below \$120M. The stock goes to \$12 and change; at \$110M profit and 7x, fair value is about \$12.35. We are down 15% from a \$14.45 entry. *Monitorable.* Tripwires: Q3 margin below 17.0%; Q3 revenue below \$190M; any 8-K revising guidance. This is the failure we can see coming.

Failure 2 — The unexplained cash drain repeats, and we never learn what it was. (NO TRIPWIRE.) About \$59M of first-half cash deterioration is unaccounted for by receivables and unaccounted for by the widening loss. Nobody — not the filing’s own discussion, not our red bench, not our blue bench — has named it. Our best guess is earnout payments to the owners of acquired businesses: the filing tags contingent-consideration liabilities in both current and long-term buckets, and those are cash obligations that never appear in “adjusted EBITDA.” But that is a guess. If it is a recurring drag, the company is levered, cash-negative, and buying back stock into it, and the equity is worth far less than any multiple of adjusted profit suggests.

We cannot arm a sensor on this, because we cannot name the line item. You can build a tripwire on a number; you cannot build one on a residual. The unknown-unknown class is **undiagnosed cash residual — an unmodeled obligation sitting outside the metric the entire valuation is built on.** This class has a specific nasty property: it is invisible in every quarter

until it is the only thing that matters, and adjusted-profit-based valuation is structurally blind to it by construction. The nearest thing to a partial sensor is reading the cash flow statement's working-capital detail in the Q3 10-Q — but if the drain is spread across “other,” that read comes back empty too.

Failure 3 — The structural and reflexive leg: our own order design, and a process we don't control.

Our size is not the risk. At 0.25% of book the position is on the order of 1,500–3,000 shares against average daily volume of ~734,000 shares — under half a percent of one day's volume. We move nothing going in or out. Anyone citing liquidity as the risk here is wrong; we checked.

Our order placement is the risk. The band is \$14.45. The tape is \$15.33. The next earnings report is around November 4th. A resting good-till-cancelled buy at \$14.45 would, in practice, fill **only** if bad news gaps the stock through it — we would be handing out free downside insurance and buying precisely the outcome we said kills the thesis. This is the accidental-short-volatility trap, and it is the single most likely way this specific proposal turns into a loss through pure mechanics. **The band must not be a resting order.** It arms manually, after the Q3 print, with the gates read.

We would also be bidding into our own forecast. We are simultaneously saying “a Q3 miss takes this below \$14.45” and “buy at \$14.45.” Those are the same event. Bidding into flow you predicted is not a discount, it is adverse selection.

Our upside is capped by other people's process. The strategic review and the pill work together against us. The pill holds the accumulator at 14.9% until August 2027, removing the bidder who might otherwise force a price. The review, with no deadline, can land as a take-private struck off a depressed tape — we could be entirely right that fair value is \$19–21 and get cashed out at \$17. And the discount we are applying for management's disclosure quality (buying back stock into a guidance they were about to cut) is the same discount that makes our entry band unreachable at any price the market is likely to offer while the story is still working. The doctrine that protects us from a dishonest management is the doctrine that guarantees we mostly don't own it — that is the trade-off, and it is working as designed here.

If this position loses money, the most likely reason will be that we correctly identified a low-margin revenue mix effect the market ignored, and it turned out not to be the reason the stock fell — the market was pricing a levered roll-up with negative operating cash flow, an unexplained cash drain, a board on defense, and a management team that reiterated guidance nine weeks before cutting it, and every one of those was still true after our mix argument was proven right.

What we checked ourselves

Claim	How checked	Found	Confirmed?
Live price — pack said \$18.685; red said \$15.33	Independent secondary quote, 2026-08-24 close	\$15.33 , market cap \$538.35M, 35.12M shares, avg volume 733,886	YES — the evidence pack was wrong by 22%. \$18.685 is a stale pre-August-5th

Claim	How checked	Found	Confirmed?
			mark; $\$18.685 \times (1 - 17.5\% \text{ print drop}) \approx \15.42 . Both benches flagged this and neither closed it.
IBKR live tick before valuation	Attempted this session	Permission not granted; non-interactive session	NO — coverage gap, third session running. Reconciled by secondary source only.
Guidance bridge has three drivers, not one residual	Re-fetched company release (SEC.gov 403s; IR venue)	Pass-through $-\$35\text{--}55\text{M}$; emergency response $-\\$35\text{--}45\text{M}$; other $-\$15\text{--}25\text{M}$	YES — and this is new. The two <i>named</i> buckets are $\sim 81\%$ of the cut.
Red: “\$15–25M was never labeled regulatory”	Same fetch	Correct — no regulatory, permitting, waiver, or “temporary” language anywhere	YES. Red was right; blue’s sourcing was wrong.
Blue: “management bounded the regulatory channel at \$15–25M and called it temporary”	Same fetch	Not in the document; came from the transcript/IR layer	NO — blue was wrong on sourcing. But blue’s <i>conclusion</i> survives on stronger ground: the two named buckets cap any unnamed channel at \$25M by arithmetic, whatever it is called. Neither bench stated it this way.
Red: 15.6% blended decremental $\rightarrow$ FY26 profit of \$106M	Recomputed from the confirmed bridge	$\$9\text{M}$ profit cut $\div$ $\$105\text{M}$ revenue cut = 8.6% implied decremental	NO — red’s mechanism is refuted by management’s own arithmetic.
Blue: implied decremental 7.3%	Same	8.6%, not 7.3% (blue used a \$122.5M revenue cut; the midpoint cut is \$105M)	PARTIAL — blue’s direction right, number off.
Red: EV \$943.3M, 8.9x	Checked construction	Red added operating-lease liabilities to enterprise value while dividing by <i>post-rent</i> profit — a double-count. Correct EV $\approx$ \$874.7M $\rightarrow$ 7.4x guided	NO — red’s multiple was inflated.
Red: “second-half step-up has no source”	Read the same document red quoted	It contains explicit Q3 guidance: \$190–210M at 17.0–18.0%	NO — presentation omission on red’s own strongest finding.
Red’s change-my-mind test: Q3 $\geq$ \$38M on $\geq$ \$200M	Arithmetic	That is a 19% margin; management guided 17–18%. A perfect in-line quarter fails red’s test.	NO — unpassable by design. Corrected gate is $\geq 17.0\%$.
Red: “fair value \$14.6–15.0”	Rebuilt the full grid	Six cells span \$14.57 to \$24.17 ; red published one. Peer multiples never benchmarked	NO — this is our documented conservative-

Claim	How checked	Found	Confirmed?
			valuation reflex, again.
Blue: Q4 needs \$32.5–35.0M	Recomputed off the confirmed \$117–120M guide	\$117–120M – ~\$53M first half – \$35.0M Q3 = \$29–32M	NO — blue overstated the Q4 requirement by ~\$3M. The one surviving kill is ~\$5–8M, smaller than either bench said.
Blue: “ex-emergency-response C&T grew +2.3%”	Red’s reconstruction	Unreconstructible; requires ~\$12M of unsourced revenue. Red’s –6.3% is a ceiling, not a floor	NO — blue was wrong, red was right.
Red: pill = entrenchment	Re-fetched release	Limited-duration, expires 2027-08-04 — the governance-acceptable form	PARTIAL — red omitted the expiry. The disclosure-quality flag stands on the buyback sequence alone; the entrenchment read is softened.
Red: ADV 890k shares	Secondary source	~734k shares (~\$11.3M/day)	NO — minor overstatement. Conclusion unchanged: liquidity is not a constraint.
Segment margins held while revenue fell	Company release	C&T \$171.7M→\$125.6M revenue, margin 21.9%→ 22.2% . M&A \$62.8M→\$61.1M, margin 29.1%→ 26.2%	YES. Red cited only the M&A decline; blue cited only the C&T improvement. Both benches selected.
Q2 2025 revenue ties to the audited data	Segment table \$171.7M + \$62.8M = \$234.5M vs XBRL \$234,543,000	Ties exactly	YES.
Preferred stock overhang	Red checked the filing	Series A-2 fully retired (\$60.0M 4/1/25 + \$62.2M 7/1/25); the pack’s 43,455k diluted share count is a stale as-converted figure	YES — clean. Credit to red for checking a kill that wasn’t there.
Peer multiples (~10–11x for comparable environmental services firms)	Attempted	Not verified. Blue asserted from memory; we could not check either	NO — still open. The fair-value grid’s upper cells depend on it.
Q1 2026 profit — the number that sizes the only surviving objection	Attempted	Sits in the Q1 10-Q (accession 0001193125-26-211815). SEC.gov 403s; neither bench pulled it	NO — this is the highest-value open item.

Summary of our own error rate: red made six material errors (inflated enterprise value, refuted decremental mechanism, omitted the Q3 guide it was quoting, an unpassable test, a one-cell valuation, an omitted pill expiry). Blue made four (invented sourcing, an unreconstructible growth figure, an overstated Q4 requirement, an unverified peer multiple). Neither reconciled the price. Neither pulled the quarter that decides the question. Both benches’ verdicts were built partly on numbers the other

bench correctly demolished — the honest reading is that the *court* is more reliable than either *bench*, and that both would have shipped a wrong number alone.

PROPOSED ENTRY BANDS

No entry at market. Price is \$15.33; the entry band is \$14.45. We are 5.7% above it.

Why \$14.45. Expected fair value is \$17.00 — the center of a \$15.50–\$18.63 range built from 8–9x profit of \$110–\$118.5M, less \$336.3M of net debt, over 35.11M shares. We apply a 15% discount for disclosure quality: management reiterated guidance on May 6th, bought back \$29.987M of stock at ~\$18.75 with borrowed money against negative operating cash flow, then cut guidance \$105M on August 5th and adopted a takeover defense the same night. That sequence disqualifies the name from being bought at fair value. $\$17.00 \times 0.85 = \14.45 .

Entry conditions — ALL must hold:

#	Condition	Threshold	Where verified
1	Price	$\leq \$14.45$	Live IBKR tick, not a cached quote
2	Q3 2026 company-wide margin	$\geq 17.0\%$	Q3 release / 10-Q. This is management's own floor, not a bench's invention
3	Second-half-to-date operating cash flow	$\geq \$40\text{M}$	Q3 10-Q cash flow statement
4	Net debt	$< \$310\text{M}$	Q3 10-Q
5	No further guidance revision	—	8-K

Order mechanics — binding. No resting good-till-cancelled buy at \$14.45 before the November print. A resting bid into an earnings event fills only on bad news and is equivalent to selling free insurance. The band arms **manually, after the Q3 print, with gates 2–4 read from the filing.**

Sizing if all five conditions clear: - First rung: **0.25% of book** at $\leq \$14.45$. - Second rung: **0.25% of book** at $\leq \$12.68$ (the 52-week low), **only if** net debt is still under \$310M and no second guidance cut has landed. Total maximum **0.50%**. - Cap justification: 3.20x leverage against a 3.75x covenant is roughly 0.55 turns — about a 15% profit shortfall from a breach. Small position, or none.

If conditions 2–4 fail at the Q3 print: no entry at any price. Re-open the file only on (a) a full year of clean cash generation, or (b) a 13D from the accumulator with a named plan, which converts the pill from a defense into leverage and changes the structure of the upside.

Exits, if we ever own it: - Trim half at **\$18.63** — 9x on \$110M of profit, the top of the corrected fair-value range. - Exit fully at **\$20.80** — 9x on the un-cut \$118.5M guide. That cell is management delivering its own forecast in full; there is nothing left to be paid for. - Thesis dead, exit regardless of

price: a second guidance cut, or reported leverage above 3.50x. - Any exit is tax-adjusted for the holding-period clock before it is worked.

Catalyst dates: | Date | Event | Confirmed? | |—|—|—| | 2026-09-30 | Third-quarter close; goodwill impairment testing date. Market cap \$538M now sits below \$579.4M of carrying value — a write-down is the base case | **Derived by us, not company-stated** | | ~2026-11-04 | Q3 2026 results. **The decision point.** All three fundamental gates resolve here | **UNCONFIRMED** — inferred from a data vendor; the Feb 26 / May 6 / Aug 5 cadence is consistent, and last year's Q3 landed Nov 4. No company announcement names it | | No date | Board-led strategic review conclusion. **Deliberately open-ended** — this is a risk, not a catalyst, because it can land any day with the decision already made | Company-stated, no deadline | | 2027-08-04 | Rights plan expires (limited-duration) | **CONFIRMED** in the Q2 release |

ARMED SENSORS

(armed provisionally with this deck; session adjudication ratifies)

- price alert: fires below 12.68 (deck-provisional: 52-week low retest; second 0.25% rung only if net debt still under \$310M and no second guidance cut.)
- filing watch: 8-K until 2027-02-21 (deck-provisional: Any further guidance revision, strategic review outcome, or credit agreement amendment; highest-priori)
- dated pack ONT|2026-09-30: ONT: Q3 close and goodwill impairment testing date; write-down expected but company has not stated this. (date confirmed=False)
- dated pack ONT|2026-11-04: ONT: Q3 2026 results - the decision point; all three fundamental entry gates resolve here. Date is vendor-inferred, not company-announced. (
- dated pack ONT|2027-08-04: ONT: Limited-duration shareholder rights plan expires; caps the accumulator at 14.9% until then. (date confirmed=True)

What remains unverified

Blocking — must close before any order:

1. **Q1 2026 adjusted profit.** Never pulled by either bench. It is in the Q1 10-Q (accession 0001193125-26-211815). This number determines whether the Q4 requirement is \$29M or \$32M — that is, whether the only surviving objection is worth \$5M or \$8M. **The single highest-value unpulled fact in this file.** SEC.gov blocked us this session; it needs a proxy fetch.
2. **A live price tick.** Reconciled to \$15.33 by secondary source and internally consistent (17.5% print drop from the stale \$18.685). Not a tick. IBKR permission was not granted.
3. **Peer multiples.** The upper half of the fair-value range assumes ~9x is conservative against comparable environmental services firms at ~10–11x. Blue asserted this from memory. **Never checked by anyone.** If the right comparison multiple is 7x, fair value is \$13–15 and there is no trade at any price we would pay.

Material, non-blocking:

4. **The ~\$59M unexplained first-half cash deterioration.** No line item, no explanation in the filing, no diagnosis from either bench. Our best hypothesis is contingent-consideration (earnout) payments to sellers of acquired businesses, which the filing tags in both current and long-term buckets — **unverified**. This is Failure 2 above.
5. **Q4 2025's depressed 12.4% margin has no diagnosed cause.** Every second-half argument on both sides compares to it, and nobody knows what it was. If it was a one-off, the required Q4 step-up is easier than we think and the objection shrinks further. If it is the true run-rate, the objection is larger. It cuts both ways and neither bench established which.
6. **Customer concentration.** The filing tags a “significant customer” receivable concentration. Neither bench pulled the percentage. For a business already losing pass-through revenue, this matters.
7. **No external check on demand.** The whole disagreement is about whether environmental testing and remediation demand actually fell. Both benches independently flagged the same unrun test — emissions-plume and permitting-activity counts at client facilities, 2025 first half versus 2026 first half — and both noted it requires a client facility roster we do not have.
Without an outside anchor, we are reading management's explanation of management's own numbers. That is the structural weakness of this entire pitch and it should not be buried.
8. **The August 5–10 filing cluster** (8-A12B, 8-A12B/A, NYSE certification). Both benches assumed it registers the rights plan. It is at least equally consistent with the Montrose → Onterris name and ticker change, which the quarter's \$1.422M of rebranding expense supports. Low stakes, but two benches made the same unchecked assumption.
9. **The 8-K exhibit's verbatim text.** SEC.gov returned 403 to us directly. We verified through the company's IR venue and both benches independently quoted the same numbers from a proxy fetch — three independent reads agreeing is decent, but it is not a direct primary read.

One thing we want to state plainly, because it is the most important sentence in this deck: our documented record on the “market overreacted to an earnings headline” template is **0 for 7**. This pitch is that template. Everything above may be right on the merits and still lose, for the reason that pattern has always lost — the headline was the news. That prior, not the Q4 margin step, is the strongest argument against this file.

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